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PLACEMENT DIRECTOR
Dr. Bilge Erten
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DOCTORAL STUDIES

Northeastern University
Ph.D., Economics, Expected completion May 2027

DISSERTATION COMMITTEE AND REFERENCES

Dr. Shantanu Khanna (Chair)
Assistant Professor of Public Policy and Economics
Northeastern University
1135 Tremont Street,
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Dr. James Dana
Professor of Economics and Strategy
Department of Economics and
D'Amore-McKim School of Business
Northeastern University
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Dr. Mindy Marks
Associate Professor, Department of Economics
Northeastern University
360 Huntington Avenue, 311 Lake Hall
Boston, MA 02115
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Dr. Jill Dupree (Teaching Reference)
Associate Teaching Professor of Economics
Northeastern University
360 Huntington Avenue, 309 Lake Hall
Boston, MA 02115
j.dupree@northeastern.edu

PRIOR EDUCATION

Northeastern University
M.S., Economics — May 2022
University of Puerto Rico
M.B.A., Business Administration — December 2019
B.A., Economics (Magna Cum Laude) — May 2017

CITIZENSHIP United States

LANGUAGES Spanish (native), English (native), French (basic), Portuguese (Where is the bathroom?)

SOFTWARE R, Python, SQL, Stata, JavaScript, LaTeX

RESEARCH FIELDS Primary: Health Economics
Secondary: Labor Economics

DESIRED TEACHING FIELDS Principles of Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Introduction to Econometrics, Microeconomic Theory, Industrial Organization, Labor Economics, Health Economics

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

ECON 1115 Principles of Macroeconomics (recitation ECON 1125) 2024–2026
Recitation Leader for Dr. Jill Dupree and Dr. Peter Simon
Fall 2026, Spring 2026, Spring 2025, Fall 2024, Summer 2024
Course enrollment: 400 | Four recitation sections per term, two in Spring 2026
Independently designed and taught a weekly discussion on the course material, integrating macroeconomic theory with current news and relevant applications, including original presentations and examples. Supervised, guided, and graded students' case study projects on macroeconomic issues. Held office hours and graded problem sets, discussion boards, and exams.

ECON 2316 Microeconomic Theory Spring 2026, Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant to Dr. Shantanu Khanna

ECON 2350 Statistics for Economists Summer 2025
Teaching Assistant to Dr. Gustavo Vicentini

ECON 1260 Contested Economic Issues Summer 2024
Teaching Assistant to Dr. Peter Simon

ECON 2560 Applied Econometrics (two sections) Fall 2023
Teaching Assistant to Dr. Mark Hooker

INTL 3520 Global Political Economy Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant to Dr. Bilge Erten

As a teaching assistant, graded problem sets, proctored exams, and led office hours.

RELEVANT POSITIONS

Ignite@AG Extern, Analysis Group, Boston, MA July 2025
Selected as one of 14 externs from 400 applicants for the firm's Associate Externship Program. Led a carriage dispute case exercise, working from litigation materials.

Research Assistant to Dr. John Kwoka Summer 2024
Department of Economics, Northeastern University. Built case records on concluded FTC antitrust matters for Kwoka and Valletti, *Antitrust Law Journal* 87 (2026), 593.

Research Assistant to Dr. Shawn Bhimani 2021–2024
D'Amore-McKim School of Business, Northeastern University. Supply Trace project. Led a team of four research assistants tracing apparel production networks.

Research Assistant to Dr. Bilge Erten Spring 2023
Department of Economics, Northeastern University. Collected and analyzed data for Dave, Erten, Keskin, and Zhang, *Journal of Health Economics* 104 (2025), 103073.

Quantitative Analyst, FirstBank Puerto Rico 2019–2021
Enterprise Risk Management. Validated econometric, financial, and machine learning models and certified model documentation.

Economist and Researcher, Inteligencia Economica Inc., Guaynabo, PR 2019
Wrote feasibility studies for small businesses, international corporations, and government institutions.

FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

Ph.D. Excellence Fellowship, Northeastern University 2022–2027
(Three summers of full funding and a $2,500 research allowance)
Participant, AEA Mentoring Program and the AEA Committee on the Status of Minority Groups in the Economics Profession (CSMGEP) 2026
David A. Radivonyk Fund for Student Research in Economics, Northeastern University ($1,000) 2021
Damaso "Tom" Acevedo Endowment Fund, University of Puerto Rico ($1,500) 2017–2019

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Presentations:

"Healthcare Privatization and Patient Health: Evidence from Puerto Rico"
(Job Market Paper)
APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA (*scheduled*) November 2026
American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN 2026

"Corporate Tax Incentives Retraction: Evidence from Puerto Rico"
APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA (*scheduled*) November 2026
AEA Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference, Washington, DC 2026
Economics Workshop, Department of Economics, Northeastern University (once per semester, including Summer) 2024–2026
Development Reading Group, Boston University 2024

Memberships: American Economic Association; American Society of Health Economists; American Society of Hispanic Economists; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management

WORKING PAPERS

"Healthcare Privatization and Patient Health: Evidence from Puerto Rico" (Job Market Paper) [Draft]

This paper estimates the effects on population health of shifting a large publicly financed healthcare system from direct public provision to private management. We study Puerto Rico's 1994–2000 health reform, which combined changes in facility control, payment incentives, eligibility, and access. Exploiting the reform's staggered rollout across counties, we estimate an increase in all-cause mortality of 26.96 deaths per 100,000 residents annually, equivalent to 3.7 percent of the pre-treatment mean. The mortality increase is accompanied by a contraction in ambulatory healthcare services, fewer hospitals, and lower use of early prenatal care, consistent with reduced provider capacity and access to timely care as possible mechanisms. The estimated mortality increase persists across alternative specifications and identification strategies. These findings suggest health costs from a broad reorganization of publicly financed care and support evaluating patient outcomes and provider capacity alongside expenditure when assessing transitions to private management.

"Corporate Tax Incentives Retraction: Evidence from Puerto Rico" [Draft]
We know much about the effects of introducing place-based tax incentives for corporations. Given how costly these incentives are, we know surprisingly little about their effects once they are retracted. To fill this gap, this paper studies the retraction of one of the costliest corporate tax incentives in the United States, Section 936 of the U.S. Internal Revenue Code. This incentive exempted U.S. corporations from federal tax on income earned in Puerto Rico from 1976 until Congress phased it out beginning in 1996 and eliminated it in 2006. Manufacturing claimed 98 percent of the tax credits and produced a median 45.5 percent of island GDP at the time, making it one of the most important industries in the economy. Using synthetic difference-in-differences on employment data for Puerto Rico and U.S. states, this paper estimates that manufacturing employment fell 9.2 percent by 2000, 13.3 percent by the close of the phase-out in 2005, and 28.0 percent by 2019, relative to the counterfactual. Results show no return to baseline employment levels two decades later. The average county-level decline is 13.6 percent, and reaches 18.2 percent in high-poverty counties. This evidence leads us to conclude that even after three decades of tax subsidy, the retraction of place-based tax incentives fails to ignite self-sustaining industries.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

"Physician Migration from Puerto Rico and the Health of Receiving Communities" with Jori Barash (University of Oregon)
This paper studies whether physician arrivals improve healthcare access and population health in receiving communities. Physicians' location choices make it difficult to distinguish the effects of physician supply from differences in local healthcare demand. We examine physician migration from Puerto Rico to mainland U.S. counties following Hurricane Maria in September 2017. Our instrumental variables strategy uses the pre-hurricane geographic distribution of the Puerto Rican diaspora to predict physician arrivals. Using data from 2012 to 2022, we study preventable hospitalizations on Hispanic communities to measure homophily benefits on patient adherence.